QHACKATHON

Participant Handbook

Sponsored by

QUANDELA CLASSIQ Infleqtion rigetti Unitary Foundation OQC

girlsinquantum.com

Welcome to the Q-volution Hackathon!

Over the next week, you will learn from industry leaders, form global teams, and build quantum solutions for real-world problems.

This handbook contains everything you need to successfully navigate the Bootcamp and the Weekend Sprint. Please read it carefully.

Sponsored by

QUANDELA CLASSIQ Infleqtion rigetti Unitary Foundation OQC

girlsinquantum.com

Quick Start Checklist

☑ Join the Discord Server

- Join the Girls in Quantum Discord server: Click Here
- Important: You will not see the hackathon channels immediately.
  - Navigate to the **#hackathon_checkin** channel under the **Lobby** category and create a ticket. **Write your email address and Discord username (exactly the ones you used in your application) in the ticket channel,** and a **Q-Organizer** will verify and assign you a **Q-Hacker** role and this will unlock the private **Q-Hackathon** category.

☑ FORK the Preparation Materials Repository

- The preparation materials are being hosted here.
- FORK and CLONE the repository.

☑ Create your Aqora Account

- Register for a free account on **Aqora**.
- Note on Aqora: We are hoping to use Aqora only for reading the official Challenge details and submitting your final projects. Further instructions will be shared on **#hackathon-announcements channel.**

☑ #hackathon-announcements channel

- **Please always keep an eye on the #hackathon-announcements channel as we will share the updates here. We will ping you using @Q-Hacker tag.**

☑ Say Hello!

- Introduce yourself in the **#lounge** **(MAKE SURE IT IS IN THE Q-Hackathon Category. DO NOT SPAM THE GENERAL CHANNELS)** and share where you are from!

Sponsored by

QUANDELA CLASSIQ Infleqtion rigetti Unitary Foundation OQC

girlsinquantum.com

Bootcamp Schedule

All times are in Eastern Time (New York) . Please convert to your local timezone!
Note that the underlined text is clickable.

February 23, 2026

Mon	11:30 AM	*Opening Announcement on Discord*
Mon	09:00 PM	***Keynote: Maria Salatino, Rigetti***

February 24, 2026

Tue	11:00 AM	***Technical Workshop: Cassandre Notton, Quandela***
Tue	12:00 PM	*Guided Team Formation & Networking (Discord)*

February 25, 2026

Wed	10:00 AM	***Classiq Resource Watch Party***
Wed	11:00 AM	***Rigetti QAOA Resource Tour***
Wed	11:59 PM	🚨 *HARD DEADLINE - Final Track Selection*

February 26, 2026

Thu	10:00 AM	***Keynote: Gloria Clausen, Infleqtion***

Sponsored by

QUANDELA CLASSIQ Infleqtion rigetti Unitary Foundation OQC

girlsinquantum.com

Sprint & Judging

All times are in Eastern Time (New York) Please convert to your local timezone!
Note that the underlined text is clickable.

February 27, 2026

Fri	09:00 AM	*HACKING BEGINS! (Challenge PDFs unlock)*

February 28, 2026

Sat	09:00 AM	*Mentorship Block 1 (EU/Asia Friendly)*
Sat	03:00 PM	*Mentorship Block 2 (Americas Friendly)*

March 1, 2026

Sun	03:00 PM	*HARD SUBMISSION DEADLINE*

March 7, 2026

Sat	10:00 AM	***Closing remarks***
Wed	10:10 AM	***Keynote: Maria Violaris, OQC***
Wed	10:25 AM	***Top 5 finalist pitches begin***
Wed	11:30 AM	***Winner announcements and Best Project Award***

Sponsored by

QUANDELA CLASSIQ Infleqtion rigetti Unitary Foundation OQC

girlsinquantum.com

Team & Track Selection

Team Rules:

Teams must consist of **3-5 members.** You cannot work alone.
If you applied without a team, use the **#team-formation** channel on Discord to find teammates with complementary skills (e.g., mix beginners with experienced coders!).

Locking in Your Track:

By Wednesday, **Feb 25 at 11:59 PM ET**, your team captain must formally select which Track (A, B, C, or D) your team will compete in. **We will share the instructions for how to submit your final team details on #hackathon-announcements channel. Also, you can only submit a project for one track.**

Challenge Tracks & Pre-requisites

Track A: Rigetti Computing (Advanced)

- **Theme**: Energy Grid Optimization
  - Maximizing the Power Energy Section using QAOA

- **Difficulty**: Advanced
  - Requires strong Python/Qiskit/pyQuil knowledge.

- **Special Restriction**: Due to hardware limits, **only 10 teams** will be granted access to Rigetti's Ankaa-3 QPU. We will shortlist a few promising candidates and reach out to them via email with further instructions.
- **Note that** Track A itself is not selective, but Rigetti's QCS access is. Even if your team doesn't get QCS access, you can still complete the Track A project using popular quantum SDKs.

- **Pre-requisite**: Read the research paper "Optimization via Quantum Preconditioning" (Dupont et al.) provided during Wednesday's Resource Tour. For the full study resources guide, Click Here

Challenge Tracks & Pre-requisites

Track B: Quandela (Advanced)

- **Theme**: Option Pricing in Finance using Quantum Machine Learning (QML).

- **Difficulty**: Intermediate
  - Machine Learning background preferred

- **Pre-requisite**: All team members aiming for Track B must create a free account at [Click Here to Access Quandela's Training Platform] prior to Tuesday's technical workshop to access the MerLin SDK and tutorials. We highly encourage you to Visit This Repository for the full list of preparation materials.

Challenge Tracks & Pre-requisites

Track C: Classiq (Intermediate)

- **Theme**: Solving Linear Differential Equations
  - Quantum Harmonic Oscillator
- **Difficulty**: Intermediate
  - Physics/Math background helpful
- **Pre-requisite**: Review the "Classiq 101" documentation and the Tao Xin et al. (2020) paper during Wednesday's Resource Watch Party. The Preparation Guide can be found **here**.

Challenge Tracks & Pre-requisites

Track D: Infleqtion UK (Beginner Friendly)

- **Theme**: Quantum for Good / Social Impact.
- **Difficulty**: Beginner
  - Focuses on conceptual problem-solving, real-world impact, and system-level thinking.
- **Pre-requisite**: Brainstorm how quantum concepts can address UN Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs). This prep guide might give you some confidence!

Submission Guidelines & Judging

How to Submit (Sunday, March 1 @ 3:00 PM ET):

One team member must submit the following items via the Aqora platform:

Code Repository
A public link to your team's GitHub repository containing your code and a detailed README.md file explaining how to run it. If you're a Track D hacker, submit a link to your Design Document or Prototype (e.g., Figma, Canva, or a PDF hosted on Google Drive) instead of code.

Summary Slide
A 1-page PDF summarizing the problem, your quantum approach, and the results.

Video Pitch
A maximum 3-minute video (hosted unlisted on YouTube or Google Drive) of your team presenting the project.

How You Will Be Judged:

Initial submissions will be graded by our Technical Mentors asynchronously. Each track has specific technical criteria, but all projects are generally weighted on:

- **Accuracy / Technical Merit**
- **Creativity / Novelty**
- **Presentation / Documentation**

The top team from each of the 4 tracks, plus 1 wildcard team, will advance to the Grand Finale on March 7 to pitch live to VIP Judges from NVIDIA, Oxford Quantum Circuits, Quantinuum, and QAI Ventures for the Grand Prize!

Sponsored by

QUANDELA CLASSIQ Infleqtion rigetti Unitary Foundation OQC

girlsinquantum.com

The Much Awaited Prize Pool

- **Track A (Rigetti):**
  - Winner: **$1,850**
  - Runner-Up: **$950**
- **Track B (Quandela):**
  - Winner: **$1,850 + Quandela QPU Credits**
  - Runner-Up: **$950**
- **Track C (Classiq):**
  - Winner: **$650**
  - Runner-Up: **$250**
- **Track D (Infleqtion):**
  - Winner: $475 (Winner Takes All)

👑 GRAND CHAMPION (Best Overall Project):

Chosen from the 5 finalists, the Grand Champion team will receive **100,000 shots on an Oxford Quantum Circuits (OQC) superconducting quantum computer** to advance their research!

Need Help?

SOS

Hackathons are challenging, but you are not alone!

Technical Questions:

Post in your specific **#track-** channel on Discord during the Sprint. **NOTE THAT THESE CHANNELS WILL UNLOCK DURING THE SPRINT.** Mentors will be active during the designated Mentorship Blocks on Saturday.

Admin/Platform Questions:

ALWAYS KEEP AN EYE ON #hackathon-announcements FOR ANY NEW INFORMATION.

Post in the **#help-desk channel**, and a Girls in Quantum organizer will assist you.

Remember: The goal is to learn, collaborate, and push the boundaries of what is possible. Have fun, drink water, and get some sleep!

Empowering the Future of Quantum.
— The Girls in Quantum Team

Sponsored by

QUANDELA CLASSIQ Infleqtion rigetti Unitary Foundation OQC

girlsinquantum.com